

נשא has a great זכות to be the longest פרשה of the תורה. All the מפרשים point out that it's the first leining we have after שבועות, because we want to show our love of תורה, so Hashem gives us an especially long שטיקל of תורה.

There are a number of wonderful topics in נשא, the one I've chosen is ברכת כהנים. In the past, we've tried to connect the beginning and end of various sections of תורה, and we'll try to do the same here. The ברכת כהנים starts with (6:23) וַיְהִי כִּי יִשְׂרָאֵל בָּרַךְ אֶת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל. The whole ברכת כהנים is a ברכה. The last three words of ברכת כהנים are וַיֵּשֶׁם לָךְ שְׁלוֹם. What is the connection between the beginning and the end?

With two little וערטלאך of R' Chaim Kanievsky from his sefer on chumash, I think we'll find an important connection and an important lesson. The גמרא in ב' עמוד דף ברכות teaches us that one who has a bad dream should stand in front of the כהנים when they give the ברכה of ברכת כהנים, and recite a special formula requesting from Hashem that he change the dream to good. If you look in every מהזור, every סידור, you'll see it. We use it. R' Chaim related that he once saw the explanation as to what is the connection between nullifying a bad dream and ברכת כהנים. Two דפים later, on ג' עמוד ב' דף, Chazal tell us that a dream is one-sixtieth of נבואה. ברכת כהנים is considered to be a real נבואה. Why? Because Hashem gives us the ברכה that the כהנים are relating and they're doing a מצות עשה. So ברכת כהנים is on a super high level, higher than we ever dreamed of, it's a נבואה. Now, as we well know, the הלכה is that things become בטל בשישים. Since a dream is one-sixtieth of what a נבואה is, and ברכת כהנים represents a נבואה, the dreamer is nullifying the bad dream in the positive effect of the נבואה of ברכת כהנים. ברכת כהנים is a נבואה, it's a full נבואה, and a חלום is one-sixtieth of a נבואה. So one-sixtieth plus sixty is sixty-one. It's בטל בשישים. By the way, he brings down, how many letters in ברכת כהנים? You can ask this of all your friends and neighbors. Sixty letters. So therefore, it has the ability through the כח of being a נבואה of being מבטל the bad חלום in שישים.

Another שטיקל from R' Chaim. One of his sons completed סדרי משנה when he was ten and a half years old. For the celebration, R' Chaim wrote him a וערטל: The final משנה in ש"ס teaches us: אָמַר רַבִּי שְׁמַעוֹן - בֶּן חֶלְפָתָא, לֹא מֵצָא הִקְדוּשׁ בְּרוּךְ הוּא כְּלִי מְחֻזָּק בְּרָכָה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל אֲלָא הַשְּׁלוֹם, שְׁנַאמַר ה' עַז לְעַמּוֹ יִתֵּן ה' יִבְרַךְ אֶת עַמּוֹ בְּשְׁלוֹם - Hashem found no vessel, no כלי, to contain ברכה for Jews better than שלום. What is it about שלום that makes it such a tremendous כלי for ברכה? The גמרא in בבא מציעא teaches us that ברכה cannot be found in anything that is measured or counted. תלמידי חכמים increase שלום in the world, see the גמרא in ברכות דף ס"ד עמוד א' in גמרא. Since the amount of שלום is not fixed, but is constantly increasing through the influence of the תלמידי חכמים, it is a perfect כלי for ברכה since it is never measured precisely, it's always increasing. It goes up to infinity. There's an infinite amount of תורה that we can learn. We have to get going and start doing our portion of התורה.

